Development Management Consultation Response
Landscape Architect: Andrew Norris
Date: 14/07/2022

Reference:	Site:	Proposal:	Case Officer:
S/COND/21/1998	*Land North Of A420, Eastern Villages, Swindon*	*Discharge of condition 6 (Phasing Plan) from previous outline permission S/OUT/13/1555*	*Edward Snook*

Summary of Landscape response

- No Comment/No Objection	☐
- No Objection/ Subject to conditions	☐
- Not acceptable in its current format/subject to changes described below	☒
- Objection in principle	☐

Executive Summary

Thank you for consulting the Landscape Section of the PLACEmaking Team.

Overview: This updated iteration of the phasing plan appears (in principle) to be an improvement over that presented previously (Feb '22), including as it now does the strategic route through the South Marston (West) development. I repeat however comments raised previously: 'Whilst the 106 sets out trigger points for delivery of the formal open space typologies, the 'General Open Space' GI provision could foreseeably be left to the end of the build out period.

I would strongly urge that delivery of the green infrastructure / structural planting etc. is instead not left until other works are concluded, but provided as early as practicable, to ensure that this important green infrastructure is in place for the benefit of residents at the earliest opportunity, and a commitment to this clearly set out in the Phasing Plan.'

Full Comments

1. Review of 'Broad Phases of the Development' Plan against previous iteration

1.1 This revised phasing plan supersedes the information presented in February, and rather than the previous placement of the last phase four being placed at the western side of the site, the initial phase occupies a much larger, more central area than it did previously. This is now located over the South Marston East and Rowborough Central phases, with subsequent phases progressing outward both to the east and west, rather than the previous broadly eastward buildout.

1.2 This iteration of the phasing plan appears in principle to be an improvement over that presented previously, as it now includes the strategic route through the S. Marston West development.

1. Conclusions: This updated iteration of the phasing plan appears (in principle) to be an improvement over that presented previously.

2. Concerns regarding Strategic Landscape delivery

2.1 I reiterate comments raised previously, that as reflected on p17 of the Phasing Details document, I am concerned that 'whilst the 106 sets out trigger points for formal open space typologies(LEAP/NEAP/Allotments/

Sports Pitches/Community hub), the 'General Open Space' GI provision could foreseeably be left to the end of the build out period, at 95% occupancy.

I would strongly urge however, that delivery of the green infrastructure / structural planting etc. is instead not left to the end of the build out period, but is provided as early as practicable, to ensure that this important green infrastructure is in place for the benefit of residents at the earliest opportunity, and a commitment to this set out in the Phasing Plan.'

2. Conclusions: Provision of 'General Open Space' should not be left to the end of the delivery programme as indicated. Whilst soft landscape works in particular may need more careful phasing, to ensure conflict with other adjacent ongoing works are minimised / controlled, this does not mean that strategic landscape works should be entirely left to the end of the build out programme.

Whilst the 'Broad Phases of the Development' Plan itself appears acceptable in principle, the principle of General Open Space provision being left to the end of the build out period is not, and forms the basis for my position that this is 'Not acceptable in its current format'.